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Real Easy English

Talking about friends

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This is a transcript of a spoken conversation and is not a word-for-word script.

Georgie

Hello! Welcome to Real Easy English from BBC Learning English. I'm Georgie.

Neil

And I'm Neil. We're here to help you improve your English with a real conversation in easy English.

Georgie

If you want to read along, you can find a text version of this podcast at bbclearningenglish.com.

Right, let's start the show. How are you today, Neil?

Neil

I'm very well, thank you, Georgie. What are we talking about in this episode?

Georgie

Today is all about friends. We'll talk a bit about our friends and why they are important.

Neil

Great, let's get started.

Georgie

So, Neil, do you have a lot of friends?

Neil

Yes, I do have quite **a few** friends. How about you?

Georgie

Yes, I also have quite a lot of friends. I've lived in different places, so I have made friends in lots of different areas and times of my life.

Neil

So, Georgie, you said that you have lived in lots of places, and I know you have lived in Spain. So, do you have lots of friends in Spain?

Georgie

Yes, I have **a few** friends in Spain. But now that I live in London, it's quite difficult to **stay in touch with** them. But, actually, one of them is coming to visit this weekend.

Neil

Ah! So you try to **keep in touch with** some of your friends. That means to keep contact with them, to make sure that you stay friends by speaking to them.

Georgie

Yes, exactly. And if you have a lot of friends, it can be difficult to **stay in touch with** so many.

What do you like to do with your friends, Neil?

Neil

Well, I like to talk to them, mainly. So, I like to meet them maybe in a pub or restaurant, or we go to a sports match sometimes and we... and we talk there and have a good time.

Georgie

That sounds nice.

Neil

How about you?

Georgie

Yes, I'm the same. During the week I think a nice plan is to go out for dinner with friends. At the weekends I like going for a walk or getting a coffee with friends.

Neil

You can do both of those at the same time!

Georgie

Yeah. That's right. Sometimes I meet friends, we get a coffee to take away and then go for a walk around the park.

Neil

And are you happy about the number of friends you have? Or would you like to have more or fewer?

Georgie

I always like making new friends. If you start a new hobby or you move to a different place there are always more people and new people to meet. I like making friends. What about you?

Neil

Yes, but I like to see my old friends and if I make new friends, I know it's something that happens slowly and that's OK.

Now we have used this word friends a lot, but there are other words for friends too aren't there?

Georgie

Yes. One is **mate**. I use **mate** a lot. We also use, **pal**. So sometimes I refer to my friends that are girls as **gal pals**.

Neil

Gal pals. That's a nice expression.

Georgie

So, Neil, why are friends important to you?

Neil

Ah, yes, good question! Friends are important I think because you can be yourself with your friends. You don't have to pretend if they're good friends because they know you as you are. And that's not the same everywhere you go in life.

Georgie

Yep, that's true!

Neil

Let's recap the language we learned during the conversation.

Georgie

We learned **mates** and **pals**, which are other words for friends.

Neil

We heard **keep in touch with**, which means see or speak to someone regularly.
We also say **stay in touch**.

Georgie

And **a few**, which means more than two, but not many. So I have **a few** friends in Spain, but not many.

Neil

Thanks for listening to Real Easy English. Visit our website for more activities and courses to help you with your English: bbclearningenglish.com.

Georgie

Next time, we'll talk about holidays and places we would like to go.

Neil

See you then, goodbye.

Georgie

Bye!